

**University of Santo Tomas
Institute of Information and Computing Sciences**

**INSTITUTE OF INFORMATION AND COMPUTING
SCIENCES STUDENT COUNCIL CONSTITUTION 2015**

PREAMBLE

We, the students of the Institute Of Information and Computing Sciences of the University of Santo Tomas, imploring the aid of Divine providence, ever conscious of our responsibilities as members of this Catholic Institution, in order to establish a genuine and dynamic Student Council that shall embody our ideals, promote the students' welfare, advance students' rights, develop, direct and channel our ICS skills, knowledge, and talents toward nation-building, and commit ourselves to the interest of the Filipino people, do hereby ordain and promulgate this Constitution.

**Article I – DECLARATION OF PRINCIPLES AND
OBJECTIVES**

Section 1. The UST-ICSSC shall uphold the Thomasian values, ideals and objectives of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences.

Section 2. The prime duty of the UST-ICSSC shall be to defend and protect the rights of the students of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences.

Section 3. The UST-ICSSC shall promote physical, intellectual, cultural, social, and spiritual well-being of the students of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences.

Section 4. The UST-ICSSC shall subscribe to the policy in cooperation with the Administration, Institute, and other sectors of the University in promoting academic freedom, common interests and welfare of the students.

Section 5. The UST-ICSSC shall strive to:

- a. serve as an active forum of ideas and influence students' involvement in activities, local and university-wide, that will enhance the students' social wellness.
- b. unite various sectors in the pursuit of common interests.
- c. develop a responsible student body which will put educational opportunity to maximum use and look after the unity and welfare of the students.
- d. promote awareness and involvement in national issues.
- e. represent the student body where their rights and interests are concerned.
- f. encourage students' involvement in the community development projects.
- g. ensure the full participation of the student body in all its endeavors.

Section 6. The Institute of Information and Computing Sciences Student Council shall serve as the official liaison

between the student body, College and the university officials.

Section 7. The ICS Student Council shall be involved in activities that will lead to the intellectual, spiritual and social uplifting of the students, provided that prior notice shall be given to other organizations recognized by the college and upon approval of the Institute administration.

Section 8. The ICS Student Council shall represent the Institute in any activity inside and outside the University which deals with matters of interest to the students.

Section 9. The ICS Student Council shall enjoy fiscal autonomy and shall have a just share in the distribution of the funds as may be provided by this constitution.

Article II – STUDENT RIGHTS AND OBLIGATIONS

Section 1. Each student shall have and enjoy all the rights accorded to him or her as provided for by the policies, guidelines and procedures governing the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences, the University of Santo Tomas and the Commission on Higher Education or its equivalent. Such rights shall not be denied to any student due to differences in race, religion, belief or academic standing.

Section 2. Every student shall have the following rights:

- a. to express himself in accordance with one's constitutional rights as provided for by the law; and to formulate his own opinion;
- b. to his own religious beliefs and practices;
- c. to confidentiality of his or her grades;

- d. to organize or join assemblies not contrary to law; and to have such organization, club, association, or society recognized by the University;
- e. against cruel and unjust punishment;
- f. to be heard and to have a proper body decide in cases of disciplinary action; and
- g. to petition the University for redress of grievances.

Section 3. Under no circumstances shall any student be denied admission and/or scholarship to the University on account of political or religious beliefs, membership in any student organization, physical handicap, socio-economic status and sexual orientation.

Section 4. Students shall have the right to express their views on any matters, inside or outside the classroom, free from any intimidation, threat, force, violence or other vices of consent.

Section 5. Students shall have the right to conduct surveys and discuss their findings and recommendations with the acknowledgement of the proper body.

Section 6. Students shall have the right to invite off-campus speakers of their choice in symposia, fora, and other similar activities without hindrance from school authorities provided that they have been approved by the Office concerned.

Section 7. No student shall be compelled to attend gatherings, seminars, fora, assemblies and other activities inside or outside the campus, except those that are required

for course completion as specified in the course syllabus.

Section 8. Within the first week, every start of the semester, the students shall be provided by their respective teachers the course syllabus for each subject that will be followed strictly. It shall consist of the course description, course outline, course requirements, class rules, grading system and the teacher's contact hours among others.

- a. Students shall have the right to be informed in writing, through the course syllabus how they will be evaluated in class every start of the semester. Accordingly, they have the right to receive a grade based upon fair and just evaluation of their performance as measured by standards specified in the course syllabus. Students, if necessary, shall have the right to request for reconsideration of grades.
- b. Students shall have the right to meet their teachers every meeting for the entire semester according to the schedule printed on the registration form. They have the right to be consulted on subsequent revisions in the class schedule, and to disagree to such revisions if the same would give them difficulties, personal or academic
- c. Students shall have the right to be informed of any change in the course syllabus initiated by the teacher that occurred after the first week of the semester.

Section 9. Students shall have the right to file a written complaint against unreasonable deadlines and expensive

requirements imposed by their teachers.

Section 10. No student shall be required to attend special classes, especially during holidays, except in cases when the class has given its consent.

Section 11. Students shall have the right to be informed of their class standing not later than two weeks following the preliminary examination.

Section 12. Students shall have the right to look at and go over their corrected quizzes and related requirements before the next major examination (preliminary and final examination) is administered to them and the right to issue a written complaint against the teacher who failed to comply.

Section 13. Students shall have the right to be shown computation and other relevant information pertaining to their final grade, and to challenge its correctness and reliability. Pursuant thereto, the administration shall endeavor to provide students reasonable amount of time in making appeals to their respective teachers for any change of grades before the scheduled release of clearance.

Section 14. Students shall have the right to file complaint against any member of the academic community for violation of his/her rights as a student.

Section 15. Students have the right to receive quality education through constant improvement in facilities and efficient teaching; in this regard, students shall have the right to present their feedback in relation to their respective curricula, evaluate tenured and non-tenured teachers, administrative officials, and other personnel of the school at the end of each semester.

Section 16. The right of the students to information on

matters directly affecting their welfare and interest shall be recognized. Access to official records and other pertinent documents and papers pertaining to official acts, transactions or decisions affecting their interest and welfare shall be afforded the students subject to institutional regulations.

Section 17. In case of school fee increase in the succeeding school year, students shall have the right to consultation before the end of the current school year.

Section 18. Students shall have the right to express their sentiments against school policies affecting the students by presenting complaints, petitions and the like to the concerned official body.

Section 19. Students are free to assist or join any recognized group, organization, alliance or federation within the campus for any lawful purposes.

Section 20. Students subjected to disciplinary proceedings shall have the right to defend themselves, to be heard and to present their evidence on their behalf before an impartial body.

Section 21. Penalties of suspension, probation, expulsion or any other disciplinary sanctions that may be rendered to a student shall not be valid unless the following rights have been observed and accorded the student:

- a. to be informed in writing of the nature and the cause of the accusation against him/her;
- b. to be assisted by counsel, parent(s) or guardian(s);
- c. to appeal the decision of the Student Welfare and Development Board to the appropriate

offices or education agencies; and,

- d. to have their parents present during their defense in a hearing conducted by the Office involved.

Section 22. Students shall have the right to disciplinary sanctions which are corrective rather than punitive or penal in nature. The gravity of disciplinary sanctions shall be proportionate to the seriousness of the offense.

Section 23. It shall be the duty and obligation of each student to observe and honor the rules of the University, to uphold the Constitution, and the rules and decisions which shall be promulgated by the UST ICS Student Council and the UST Central Student Council.

Section 24. It shall be the duty of each student to respect the rights of others in his/her exercise of his/her individual rights.

Section 25. It shall be the obligation of each student to provide an atmosphere conducive to learning in the University.

Section 26. It shall be the duty of each student to uphold and esteem moral values, virtues, and sense of justice and uprightness.

Section 27. It shall be within the responsibility of each student to continually uplift the Thomasian standard of education.

Section 28. No student shall be denied the opportunity to take the periodical or major examination for inability to pay what is due for tuition and other school fees, subject to reasonable

guidelines or conditions, which may be imposed by the Office of the Vice Rector for Finance. However, students with outstanding balance who are allowed to take an examination shall, nevertheless, be subject to the right of the university to withhold the release or issuance of such students' records, or of documents mentioned in the immediately preceding section to deny such student's admission in the next succeeding semester or year until prior balance/s is/are paid.

Article III- INFORMATION AND COMPUTING SCIENCES STUDENT COUNCIL

Section 1. In pursuance of the objectives and principles set forth in this Constitution, the UST-ICSSC shall act as the student government of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences.

Section 2. The UST-ICSSC shall be composed of the Executive Board and the ICS Legislative Board.

- a. The Executive Board shall be composed of the elected officers as stipulated under Section 2, Article IX of this Constitution.
- b. The ICS Legislative Board shall be composed of all class presidents of first to fourth year levels.

Section 3. The Executive Board with the ICS Legislative Board shall define the position of the UST-ICSSC on vital issues such as, but not limited to, tuition fee increase, violation of students' rights, issuance of a political stand as well as issues of National concern.

Section 4. The UST-ICSSC shall represent the student populace of the Institute of Information and Computing

Sciences in all matters concerning the studentry; and all decisions or course of action reached or made by the UST-ICSSC shall be binding on the ICS students

Section 5. The UST-ICSSC shall make recommendations to the University and/or the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences concerning policies or activities affecting students' welfare. Upon invitation, they shall have the right to attend, participate and vote on matters directly affecting the students.

Section 6. The UST-ICSSC shall act as the link of communications with the other local student councils and the Central Student Council.

Section 7. The UST-ICSSC shall organize activities and services that will promote the general welfare of the ICS students.

Section 8. The UST-ICSSC shall adopt its own rules on internal government provided they shall not be inconsistent with this Constitution

Section 9. The UST-ICSSC shall inform the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences students about the Council's activities, especially those that affect their welfare and interest.

Section 10. The UST-ICSSC shall organize an annual Leadership Training Seminar (LTS) for student leaders in the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences.

Article IV – THE ICS LEGISLATIVE BOARD (ILB)

Section 1. The ICS Legislative Board shall be the legislative body of the UST-ICSSC. It shall be the highest policy-making organ of the student populace of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences and shall be responsible for formulating policies, rules and regulations directly affecting the welfare and interest of the students in pursuance of the objectives and principles of this Constitution.

Section 2. The ICS Legislative Board shall be composed of all class presidents of first to fourth year levels. The UST-ICSSC Internal Vice President shall be an ex-officio member.

Section 3. The ICS Legislative Board shall convene and hold a Semestral Congress on dates set by the Internal Vice President of the Executive Board which shall not be later than forty five days from the start of classes.

Section 4. The ICS Legislative Board shall elect a Speaker, a Deputy Speaker, and a Secretary, who shall be voted by the ILB members.

- a. Speaker – Is the Official Spokesperson of the ICS Legislative Board ; acts as the presiding officer of the ILB in all the official meetings. Also, acts as the representative of the ILB.
- b. Deputy Speaker – Acts as the presiding officer of the ILB in all official meetings if the Speaker is unable to attend; exercises the power of the Speaker upon notification that a temporary vacancy exists in the position of the Speaker.
- c. Secretary – Keeps the records of the ILB and

ensures its confidentiality; prepares all the letters and notices of the ILB.

Section 5. A simple majority (50% plus 1) of the members of the ICS Legislative Board shall constitute a quorum.

Section 6. The ICS Legislative Board shall be responsible for the approval of the general policies, rules and regulations for the administration of the UST-ICSSC, and other matters of interest proposed by the Executive Board that concern the entire ICS Student Body

Section 7. The ICS Legislative Board shall have the power to propose projects to the Executive Board that will promote common interest for the student populace.

Section 8. The ICS Legislative Board shall have the power to request from the Executive Board, documents and/or reports which they may deem necessary in the exercise of their duties with the approval of the Executive Board.

Section 9. The ICS Legislative Board shall have the power to conduct a monthly meeting with all the class presidents of first to fourth year levels of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences whenever necessary.

Article V- THE EXECUTIVE BOARD

Section 1. The Executive Board is the official representative of the ICS students in their dealings with the University/College and with the Central Student Council with regard to the academic, social, and policy-making activities which concern student populace.

Section 2. The Executive Board is responsible for the implementation of policies, rules and regulations concerning affairs which will promote the welfare and interests of the ICS students.

Section 3. The Executive Board is the decision maker in matters affecting the ICS students.

Section 4. The Executive Board has the power to act for in behalf of the ICS Legislative Board on matters requiring immediate decisions in the absence of the ICS Legislative Board.

Section 5. The Executive Board shall define the position of the UST-ICSSC on vital and urgent campus issues, as well as of national concern.

Section 6. The Executive Board shall have the power to create teams in the fulfillment of certain objectives, and to appoint such officers as may be required to head and populate such teams.

Section 7. The Executive Board is composed of the following officers:

- a. President
- b. Internal Vice President
- c. External Vice President
- d. Secretary
- e. Treasurer
- f. Auditor
- g. Public Relations Officer

Section 8. The Executive Board may appoint other officers as it may deem necessary in the exercise of its duties and functions, and who may head or compose various teams.

However, such appointed officials shall not be considered as belonging to the Executive Board, and as such, have no voting power in case of decisions requiring only the members of the Executive Board.

Section 9. The Team Council

a. Team Chairmen

Aspiring Team Chairmen of the ICS Student Council shall undergo a screening process deemed necessary and appropriate by the ICSSC Executive Board. Applicants should have at least one year experience in the ICS Student Council member.

b. Team Heads and Associate Team Heads

Aspiring Team Heads and Associate Team Heads of the ICS Student Council shall undergo a screening process deemed necessary and appropriate by the ICSSC Executive Board and Team Chairmen.

c. Team Members

All aspiring team members shall undergo a screening process deemed necessary and appropriate by the Team Chairmen with additional requirements that can be set by the Team Heads of each team.

- d. Team Chairmen, Team Heads, Associate Team Heads and Team Members shall be collectively known as the Team Council.

Section 10. The UST-ICSSC shall have the following Standing Teams:

- a. **Student's Rights and Welfare Team** handles all the grievances and complaints of the students. They are the students' legal counsel
- b. **Documentation and Newsletter Team** records all the proceedings and activities of the UST-ICSSC. They produce the UST-ICSSC newsletter.
- c. **Community Development Team** facilitates UST ICSSC'S community development activities such as, but not limited to the following: outreach programs, helping calamity victims and engaging in medical missions. They shall be in-charge of communicating with the different communities, orphanages and other institutions which the UST-ICSSC may want to help.
- d. **Finance Team** organizes fund raising activities, including the preparation of the project proposal to be submitted for the approval of the Executive Board.
- e. **External Affairs Team** manages all sponsorships of the UST – ICSSC. Also formulates and conceptualizes all events of the UST – ICSSC.
- f. **Creative and Technical Team** conceptualizes and designs the bulletin boards, backdrops and all the audio-visual presentations of all the projects of the UST-ICSSC.
- g. **Logistics Team** monitors and provides materials and equipment for use of the UST-ICSSC.

- h. **Publicity Team** disseminates information regarding the activities and other related activities of the UST-ICSSC.
- i. **Academics Team** handles various programs and activities set forth by the administration of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences for the intellectual progress of the students of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences.

Article VI- THE JUDICIARY BOARD

Section 1. The Judiciary Board shall have the power to subject and to try any member of the Executive Board of the UST-ICSSC through impeachment proceedings, provided that sufficient evidences and documents are presented. In this case, the Judiciary Board shall act as the Impeachment Tribunal.

Section 2. The Judiciary Board shall be composed of the following:

- a. SWDB Coordinator, Institute of Information and Computing Sciences
- b. Student Council Advisers, ICSSC
- c. Speaker, ILB

Section 3. The Judiciary Board shall decide the matter within 15 days from the time the issue is submitted for decision.

Section 4. A majority vote of all the members shall be necessary to promulgate the decision of the Judiciary Board.

Section 5. All decisions of the Judiciary Board shall be final and executed after 10 calendar days from the receipt of the notice of decision.

Section 6. The Judiciary Board shall have the following powers;

- a. To exercise exclusive original jurisdiction over impeachment cases filed against any member of the UST-ICSSC.
- b. To review, revise, reverse, modify or affirm on appeal or certiorari as the rules may provide decisions, orders, and rulings of the COMELEC in cases provided by this constitution.
- c. To mediate over all cases where a question of law is involved or in cases where their jurisdiction is invoked.
- d. To provide a simplified procedure for the just and speedy disposition of all cases brought before them.

ARTICLE VII – INFORMATION AND COMPUTING SCIENCES STUDENT COUNCIL MEMBERSHIP

Section 1. All bona fide and aspiring students of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences, regardless of the programs they are undertaking, has the privilege to become a member of the ICS Student Council immediately after admission and enrollment.

Section 2. Such membership shall cease only when non-enrolled, at the end of the academic year and if rules and regulations from UST-ICSSC Internal Rules and Regulations, UST-ICSSC Constitution, and Student's Handbook has been knowingly, freely and willfully violated.

ARTICLE VIII – PRIVILEGES AND DUTIES OF MEMBERS

Section 1. It shall be the duty of every member of the student body to respect the statutes, rules, and regulations of the University and of the Institute, to observe faithfully Christian values and tradition, and to uphold the UST-ICSSC Constitution, Vision, and Mission.

Section 2. It shall be the duty of every member of the student body to participate actively in the activities of the University and of the College.

Section 3. It shall be the duty of every officer and member of the Student Council, to foster unity, cooperation, and harmonious relationship among themselves.

Section 4. It shall be the duty of every officer to maintain, enhance, and promote a healthful ecology and clean environment within the Institute and outside it.

Section 5. Any member of the student body shall be represented by the Student Council in seeking redress for his/her grievances and/or legitimate concerns.

Section 6. All officers of the Student Council and members of the student body through their representatives, shall have the privilege to meet the Institute administration and Institute in an objective, open, free, and harmonious dialogue, otherwise known as DIALOGO, or as need arises to thresh out problems or concerns that may come from any College sector. This shall be arranged and facilitated by the Student Council Internal Vice President.

Section 7. Every member of the student body shall enjoy each other privileges that may be extended by the Student Council.

It may coordinate with the ICS Departments Students Alliance on socio-cultural activities

Article IX- QUALIFICATIONS OF THE EXECUTIVE BOARD OFFICERS

Section 1. A candidate in any position of the Executive Board shall possess the following qualifications on the day of the elections:

- a. For The President, Internal Vice President and External Vice President
 - i. A bona fide student of the University of Santo Tomas enrolled in the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences.
 - ii. Currently enrolled with a total of at least 18 units as may be certified by the Registrar
 - iii. No failures in any academic course from the entire stay at the university with the general weighted average of 2.5
 - iv. Good moral character as certified by the Institute Director.
 - v. Residency in the University for at least one year immediately preceding the elections; and,
- b. For the Secretary, Treasurer, Auditor, and the Public Relations Officer
 - i. A bona fide student of the University of Santo Tomas enrolled in the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences.

- ii. Currently enrolled with a total of at least 18 units as may be certified by the Registrar

- iii. No failures in any academic course from the semester immediately preceding the election with the general weighted average of 2.5

- iv. Good moral character as certified by the Institute Director

- v. Residency in the University for at least one semester immediately preceding the elections; and,

- vi. Shall have no failing grade during the entire A.Y. wherein he/she will be filing a candidacy.

Section 2. No officer of the Executive Board shall, during his/her tenure, hold any other position in any capacity of any recognized/class organization the Institute so as to extinguish any doubt as to his/her impartiality in handling the affairs of the UST-ICSSC.

Section 3. The candidates for Presidency shall be an incumbent officer of the ICS Student Council or in any recognized Major Organization.

Article X - RIGHTS AND DUTIES OF EXECUTIVE BOARD

Section 1. The President

- a. Is the Official Spokesperson of the UST ICSSC and has the power to appoint an official spokesperson when needed.

- b. Represents the UST-ICSSC in all the official meetings with the Administration, Institute, the Central Student Council and other youth and student organizations.
- c. Signs each outgoing documents, memorandums, papers and files for its certification and validity.
- d. Knows each and every issue in the ICS Student Council.
- e. Approves appointments of officers to the committee heads.
- f. Involves Himself or Herself in implementing new rules, policies and sanctions.
- g. Reprimands officers if he/she feels that they have neglected their duties or overstepped their position
- h. Assumes full responsibility of all activities of the ICSSC.

Section 2. The Internal Vice President

- a. serves as the official representative of the UST-ICSSC in internal relations and to report all developments to the Executive Board.
- b. Acts as the presiding officer in meeting of the UST-ICSSC if the President is unable to attend.

- c. Exercises the powers of the President upon notification that a temporary vacancy exists in the position of the President. Such exercise of the President's power applies only until the return of the President to his/her position.
- d. Succeeds the President if the President is incapacitated or a permanent vacancy exists in the position of the President.
- e. Takes charge of all teams directly responsible for any internal affairs and shall report to him/her all developments.
- f. Is the disciplinary Prefect that would take the necessary actions for any rules violated by the members of UST-ICSSC.
- g. Has other power as the Executive Board may deem appropriate to grant.
- h. Acts as the Ex-officio of the ICS Legislative Board
- i. Acts as the Officer-in-charge of the Student's Rights and Welfare Team of the ICS Student Council

Section 3. The External Vice President

- a. Serves as the official representative of the UST – ICSSC in external events and to report all developments to the Executive Board

- b. Has the power to transact matters beyond the confines of the Institute and which require extreme urgency.
- c. Act as the overall supervisor of activities held
- e. Has other powers as the Executive Board may deem appropriate to grant.
- f. Acts as the Officer-in-charge of the External Affairs Team of the ICS Student Council
- g. Acts as the Ex-officio of the ICS Sector for Student Alliance (ISSA)

Section 4. The Secretary

- a. Keeps the records of the UST-ICSSC.
- b. Prepares all the official letters and notices of the UST-ICSSC.
- c. Prepares reports of all activities, plans and accomplishments of the UST-ICSSC as certified by the President, and prepare the same for the Semestral Congress.
- d. Notes down the minutes of every meeting in an official record book.
- e. Ensures that the papers of the UST-ICSSC are kept in the highest confidence.

outside the Institute or University.

- d. Takes charge of all teams directly responsible for any external affairs and shall report to him/her all developments.
- f. Checks all the official letters and notices of the UST-ICSSC prepared by the project head.
- g. Has other power as the Executive Board may deem appropriate to grant.
- h. Acts as the Officer-in-charge of the Documentation and Newsletter Team of the ICS Student Council
- i. Acts as the Officer-in-charge of the Academics Team of the ICS Student Council

Section 5. The Treasurer

- a. Is the custodian of the Student Activity Fund (SAF) and Student Council Fund (SCF) of the UST-ICSSC and shall be accountable for them.
- b. Plans and make appropriation of funds for the various projects and activities of the UST-ICSSC.
- c. Authorizes the disbursement of the Student Activity Fund (SAF) and Student Council Fund (SCF) in accordance with the appropriations of the Executive Board.

- d. Keeps accurate track of all incoming and outgoing funds of the UST-ICSSC and of all recognized organizations in the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences and shall keep such records in an official record book.
- e. Provides an official financial statement every last
- g. Acts as the Officer-in-charge of the Finance Team of the ICS Student Council

Section 6. The Auditor

- a. Act as the custodian of all the effect and properties of the UST-ICSSC and shall be accountable for them.
- b. Inspects the financial records of the UST-ICSSC to see if there are any anomalies or discrepancies in the records and in the disbursement of funds or in the keeping of the funds.
- c. Audits the official Treasurer's financial report and to certify and reject the same based on his/her investigation and inspection of the records.
- d. Has other power as the Executive Board may deem appropriate to grant.
- e. Acts as the Officer-in-charge of the Logistics Team of the ICS Student Council
- f. Requests liquidation reports from all recognized organizations in the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences

day of the month. He/she shall also submit an official Treasurer's financial report at the end of the UST-ICSSC term and shall submit a copy of such report for examination by the student body.

- f. has other power as the Executive Board may deem appropriate to grant.

Section 7. The Public Relations Officer

- a. Communicates the exact date, time and agenda of each formal meetings of the Executive Board.
- b. Governs the rules and regulations regarding the bulletin boards that are well coordinated with the Director's Office.
- c. Acts as the speaker of the UST-ICSSC towards the student populace of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences
- d. has other power as the Executive Board may deem appropriate to grant.
- e. Acts as the Officer-in-charge of the Publicity Team of the ICS Student Council
- f. Acts as the Officer-in-charge of the Creative and Technical Team of the ICS Student Council

Article XI– ACCOUNTABILITY OF THE OFFICERS OF THE ICS STUDENT COUNCIL

Section 1. The officers of the UST-ICSSC shall serve with the highest degree of responsibility, integrity, honesty, loyalty and efficiency and shall be held responsible and accountable to the ICS student populace.

Section 2. All newly elected officers of the UST-ICSSC shall be required to take an oath stating their firm commitment to perform their duties and responsibilities.

Section 3. The officers of the Executive Board shall be liable to impeachment if they are found to have neglected their duties, committed any grave offense, or committed any action that may malign the name of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences. Such person will be subjected to an Impeachment Trial stipulated in Article XIV.

Section 4. For smaller offenses, the Executive Board may issue reprimands for the erring officer, and may provide such officer with the necessary transactions, not exceeding suspension from office for five days.

Section 5. In all cases, the officer being tried shall not participate in the votation concerning his case, whether it is for a reprimand or suspension or impeachment.

Article XII – MEETINGS OF THE UST ICS STUDENT COUNCIL

Section 1. The ICS Legislative Board shall hold a Semestral Congress to deliberate and formulate or review policies, rules and regulations for the entire semester. The Semestral Congress shall also include the deliberation of the general program of activities formulated by the Executive Board and shall be submitted for review of the ICS Legislative Board. The said Semestral Congress shall be held not later than forty five days upon the start of classes; it shall be announced in advance by the Executive Board so that adequate attendance and

representation are made.

Section 2. For the Semestral Congress, a simple majority of the members of the ICS Legislative Board will constitute a quorum to do business. Waiver of the quorum requirement can be made only when particular matter requires immediate decision, and which shall be determined by a vote of at least 75% of those present in the meeting.

Section 3. The President and/or the Speaker of the ICS Legislative Board may call special meetings to discuss relevant or urgent matters. Such meetings shall be announced at least four days in advance.

Section 4. The Executive Board of the UST-ICSSC shall hold its meetings at least once a week at a designated time, place and date set by the President or the Vice-President.

Section 5. The presence of the majority of the members of the Executive Board of the UST-ICSSC shall constitute a quorum to do business in any meeting of the Executive Board. In the absence of a quorum, the members may still discuss their business, but they shall not have the power to push through with any decision or activity unless it is with the consent of the members of the UST-ICSSC, all the members being informed of what has transpired during the meeting.

Section 6. It is the right and duty of the ICS Legislative Board and Executive Board to attend all announced meetings.

Section 7. Continued absences by any Executive Board member with no valid excuses shall carry with it corresponding sanctions. If the member of the Executive Board has been absent for three consecutive announced meetings; or absent for five non-consecutive announced meetings with no valid excuse, then the said officer is liable for suspension. If the limits set above have been breached, then the said officer is liable for impeachment for gross negligence of duty.

Section 8. All meetings of the UST-ICSSC are open to all the concerned students, except for such closed meetings it may deem appropriate to hold, wherein only the members of the Executive Board are allowed to join.

Article XIII – TENURE AND VACANCY

Section 1. All officers of the UST-ICSSC and the Executive Board shall have a term of one (1) academic year upon which to exercise their powers and duties. There shall be a transition period among the incumbent and the newly elected Executive Board members for the completion and clearance of

files and documents and the recruitment of committee heads, assistant committee heads, staff members, respectively, and other projects and concerns both parties may want to consider.

Section 2. VACANCY shall be taken to mean a position is left open and that shall be filled to maintain the composition of the UST-ICSSC to allow its proper functioning.

- a. A PERMANENT VACANCY exists when the position is left open due to an officer's death or permanent illness or disability, either physical or mental, impeachment or resignation, expulsion from the university and detainment due to a capital crime which causes the officer to completely lose command and control of his duties and obligation.
- b. A TEMPORARY VACANCY exists when the position is left open due to a temporal physical or mental illness, temporal detention, or any reason which leaves the position open, implying a strong possibility that such officer occupying the position will return to his duties.

Section 3. The newly elected Executive Board of the UST-ICSSC shall be deemed constituted upon the proclamation of the local COMELEC of the winners of the election.

Section 4. The newly elected Executive Board of the UST-ICSSC shall assume office and fully practice its duties and powers right after the turnover ceremony or its equivalent.

Section 5. In cases of permanent vacancy, the following shall be the course of action:

- a. If the permanent vacancy exists in the Office of the President, the Vice-President shall take over the post of the President and he/she shall become the new UST-ICSSC President, and shall serve the unexpired portion of the term. The new Vice-President shall be elected by the majority vote of the Executive Board of the UST-ICSSC. The candidate for Vice-President shall be one of the members of the ICS Legislative Board actively serving the current UST-ICSSC administration. The qualifications stipulated in Article IX for the vacated position shall be observed.
- b. In case of a permanent vacancy in the Office of the Secretary or Treasurer, one their respective Team Heads will take over their post, while the new Team Head is to be appointed by the Executive Board from the respective Team.
- c. In case of a permanent vacancy exists in a post not mentioned above, the position shall be filled by appointment of the Executive Board.
- d. In case there shall occur three or more vacancies considered permanent at the same

time, special elections shall be called by the UST-ICSSC to fill the vacancies in the Executive Board within thirty days that such notice of such vacancies exist, except if the permanent vacancies should occur within forty five days at the end of the school year. Officers elected through special elections shall serve only the unexpired portions of the term of their predecessors.

Section 6. In cases of temporary vacancy, the following shall be the course of action:

- a. If the vacancy occurs in the post of the President, the Vice-President for Internal Affairs shall immediately take over the post, while the post of the Vice-President for Internal Affairs is being lived temporarily vacant.
- b. If the vacancy occurs in the position of secretary downward, the Executive Board may choose from among themselves who shall function in the vacant position and at the same time hold their own positions, in effect, a person shall be appointed by the Executive Board from its own ranks and who shall hold dual positions.
- c. If the temporary vacancy occurs in three or more positions, the Executive Board may appoint other persons who are qualified to fill the vacant positions in the lower level.

Section 7. Any officer of the UST-ICSSC can be made to undergo impeachment trial whereupon a temporary vacancy occurs in the post while impeachment proceedings are in progress. If the officer should become impeached, then a permanent vacancy exists in the officer's post.

Section 8. If no President is elected during the regular elections, special elections shall be called by local COMELEC within 10 days for the purpose of electing a new President.

Section 9. If both the office of the President and Vice-Presidents are left vacant after the elections, special elections shall be called by the COMELEC for the purpose of electing a new President and Vice-Presidents in such case the normal rule on election will occur. The local COMELEC is given 10 days to call for a special election.

ARTICLE XIV – IMPEACHMENT

Section 1. Impeachment shall mean the removal of such person from his post, thus creating a permanent vacancy and disallowing such person from holding any post above the secretary level in any recognized/class organization of the College.

Section 2. In a resolution approved by simple majority (50% + 1) of the members of the ICS Legislative Board, an officer shall be made to undergo impeachment proceedings. The said resolution for impeachment shall be presented in a formal letter indicating the person to be impeached and the charges or accusations leveled against him/her, with an attached paper containing the signatures of the petitioners.

Section 3. Upon the receipt of the formal letter of complaint, the Judiciary Board shall constitute itself as an Impeachment Tribunal. It shall notify the person against whom the impeachment is filed within one week from the approval of the resolution for impeachment.

Section 4. The Impeachment Tribunal, upon its constitution shall set a schedule upon which they will hear and try the case en banc within seven days after the notification has been received. The Impeachment Tribunal shall come up with a

decision not more than twenty five days upon the start of the hearings. The decision of the Impeachment Tribunal shall be arrived at in a closed door meeting held en banc by Votation. An officer shall be considered impeached if there is a majority vote of the members of the Impeachment Tribunal in favor of the impeachment. The decision of the Impeachment Tribunal shall be final and non-appealable to any student or administrative body.

Section 5. An officer not deemed impeachable due to the offense may still be suspended on the following grounds: unwarranted physical violence, causing the physical injuries toward a fellow student (degree to be decided as to whether placed on suspension or impeachment level); speech or action that tends to destroy the credibility or reputation of the UST-ICSSC; or three unexcused absences occurring consecutively on announced meetings. The suspension must be decided by the Executive Board and needs only the consensus of the majority, the officer charged cannot vote and excluded from the total number of voted to be counted.

Article XV– THE CLASS

Section 1. The Class shall be the basic unit of the UST-ICSSC.

Section 2. The class shall be composed of all regular and irregular students enrolled in a section.

Section 3. The class shall have the following officers, to wit:

- I. President
- II. Vice President
- III. Secretary
- IV. Treasurer
- V. Public Relations Officer

Section 4. It is the duty of all the class officers to implement all

the rules, regulations, and regulations promulgated by the ICSSC, provided that they are in accordance with the provision of this Constitution and the Student Handbook.

ARTICLE XVI – QUALIFICATIONS OF CLASS OFFICERS

Section 1. A candidate to be a class officer shall possess the following qualifications during the time of his class elections that will be facilitated by the COMELEC.

- a. Be a bona fide student of the Institute of Information and Computer Studies.
- b. Be a regular member of his class.
- c. Currently enrolled with at least 15 units as certified by the Director's office.

Article XVII – THE COMMISSION ON ELECTIONS (COMELEC)

Section 1. There shall be an independent body to be called the UST Institute of Information and Computer Studies Commission on Elections (COMELEC), whose main goal is to conduct the local and university wide elections for the Executive Board of the UST-ICSSC and the UST Central Student Council, and also to conduct referenda whenever they are called by the UST-ICSSC.

Section 2. The local COMELEC shall be composed of a Chairman and seven Commissioners. The members of the COMELEC must not be affiliated with or be a member of any party competing for the elections, nor should they openly vouch or support the platforms or candidates of any party. If such is not the case, then the COMELEC member who violated the principle above must resign. The new Commissioner must be appointed by the Department Chair from which the deposed

member belongs.

Section 3. The members of the COMELEC shall represent the different departments of the UST Institute of Information and Computing Sciences. Each department is entitled to one representative.

Section 4. The following are the qualifications for the Commissioners of the local COMELEC:

- a. A bona fide student of the University enrolled in the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences.
- b. Must not be an Executive Board member of any central or local council.
- c. Must not have any affiliation with any party vying for the position at stake in the election.
- d. Must be of good moral character and integrity.
- e. Must be officially endorsed by his/her respective Department Chair.

Section 5. The local COMELEC shall have the following powers, duties and functions:

- a. To administer and enforce all the rules and regulations and guidelines concerning the conduct of the elections, or referendum, and to institute measures and devices to see such rules are followed.
- b. To release the names of the qualified candidates for the position in the Executive Board of the UST – ICSSC and the UST Central Student Council after reviewing all their qualifications
- c. To disqualify candidates for the Executive Board

of the UST-ICSSC if they fail to meet the requirements specified in Article VIII of this Constitution.

- d. To supervise the elections done through electronic voting and to judge all the election returns.
- e. To proclaim the result of the elections within 3 days after the closure of the said election.
- f. To prepare and submit a report concerning the conduct and the result of the elections or referendum to University Officials concerned and to the UST-ICSSC when it has been constituted.

Section 6. The local COMELEC shall be the sole judge concerning election returns, and any protests must be made within three days after the proclamation of the results of the previous election or referendum.

Section 7. Upon the receipt of an election protest, the local COMELEC must meet within forty eight hours to schedule a hearing where the matter will be decided en banc. The local COMELEC shall issue its decision within five days from the start of the hearing.

Section 8. The Local COMELEC shall conduct the electronic counting of the votes with witnesses from the competing parties, after all the election returns are in, the maximum of which is one hour after the closure of the polling place.

Section 9. Concerning elections, the local COMELEC shall base its decision on a simple plurality of votes cast if there are two or more opposing candidates. If there should only be one candidate, then the said candidate must get a simple majority (50% + 10 of the total turn-out votes in order to be proclaimed

winner in the elections. In case that the said candidate failed to acquire the specified number of votes, a special election shall be immediately conducted within five days after the proclamation of winners.

Section 11. Concerning referenda, a simple majority of the votes cast in the referendum shall determine the decision of the student populace, and which shall answer the question posed before the student populace.

Section 12. The voting power required should be 2/3 of the ICS student population.

Article XVIII – THE ICS SECTOR FOR STUDENT ALLIANCE (ISSA)

Section 1. The ICS Sector for Student Alliance (hereinafter referred to as ISSA), shall be the coordinating body of all recognized student organizations of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences.

Section 2. The ISSA shall be composed of the Presidents and Vice Presidents of the recognized student organizations in the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences

Section 3. The ISSA shall uphold Christian ideals and objectives of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences by promoting the socio-cultural well-being of the students of the Institute.

Section 4. The ISSA shall protect the recognized organizations' democratic rights and welfare.

Section 5. The ISSA shall serve as fora for socio-cultural development whereby the students can put into practice the principles and ideas of aesthetics, camaraderie, and

brotherhood; in coordination with the UST-ICSSC.

Section 6. The ISSA shall have its own officers.

- a. Only the officers and/or official representatives of each organization shall be qualified to run for the position in the alliance.
- b. The officers and/or official representatives from each recognized organization shall elect the set of officers.

Section 7. The ISSA shall enjoy a fiscal autonomy.

Article XIX – FUNDS

Section 1. The funds of the UST-ICSSC shall consist of student fees, particularly from the Student Council Fund (SCF) and Student Activity Fund (SAF) to be collected together with other school fees during semestral enrolment in accordance with the applicable rules and regulations of the University and the Commission on Higher education, or its equivalent.

Section 2. The UST- ICSSC shall submit a financial report at the end of the term detailing how the fund was utilized, such financial report to be formulated by the Treasurer and certified

by the Auditor will be submitted to the University Official concerned and to the student body.

Section 3. The account books and the financial condition of the UST-ICSSC shall be made available whenever a valid request is made to this effect either to the student body or to the University Official concerned.

Article XX- THE STUDENT COUNCIL ADVISER

Section 1. There shall be a Student Council Adviser and a co-adviser elected and/or recommended by the Executive Board. This shall be reviewed for approval of the Director of the IICS.

Section 2. The function of the Student Council Adviser shall be consultative or advisory in nature. Recommendation by the adviser may or may not be accepted by the UST-ICSSC.

Section 3. The Student Council Adviser shall have the privilege of attending the meetings of the UST-ICSSC. However, in cases when the Executive Board calls for a closed door meeting, the Executive Board may request the adviser to refrain from attending the meeting.

Article XXI – AMENDMENTS

Section 1. The UST-ICSSC Legislative Board by a vote of at least two third of its members, may propose an amendment in this Constitution

Section 2. The UST-ICSSC shall assign the local COMELEC to call for a referendum/plebiscite concerning the proposed amendments. The UST-ICSSC shall take charge of submitting the proposal to the student body, to inform them of what effects or changes such an amendment will do or create.

Section 3. The proposed amendment shall be deemed approved upon proclamation of the local COMELEC that a majority of the electorate in the UST Institute of Information and Computing Sciences agrees to the proposal of amending the constitution.

Article XXII - SUFFRAGE

Section 1. All bona fide students of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences shall have the right and duty to cast their vote in any election, referendum or plebiscite.

Section 2. Suffrage shall be exercised with mature responsibility.

ARTICLE XXIII – GENERAL PROVISIONS

Section 1. The term of the previous members of the ICS Student Council shall terminate of the last day of the current school year.

Section 2. All rules, regulation, resolutions and policies contrary to these by-laws are hereby repealed.

ICS Student Council Interim Executive Board



4/6/16

CHRISTIANNE SARAH ABIGAIL S. BOYDON

IICS President, '15 - '16



WENDELL O. JAPZON

IICS Vice President, '15 - '16

 4/6/16
CHARLES DAVID C. ZALAMEDA

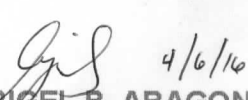
IICS Secretary, '15 - '16

 4/6/16
MARVIN JAMES C. LOPEZ

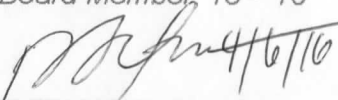
IICS Treasurer, '15 - '16

 4/6/16
KRISTINE A. AQUINO

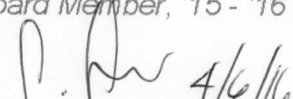
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 4/6/16
RIGEL B. ARAGON

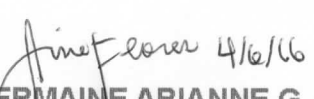
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 4/6/16
PATRICIA T. CHUA

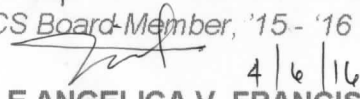
IICS Board Member, '15 - '16

 4/6/16
STEPHEN KYLE R. FARINAS

IICS Board Member, '15 - '16

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JERMAINE ARIANNE G. FLORES

IICS Board Member, '15 - '16

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NICOLE ANGELICA V. FRANCISCO

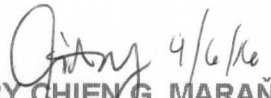
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JOEL LOUIE M. LLORENTE

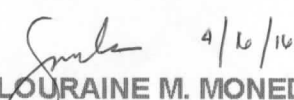
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JOHN PHILLIP C. MANOCAN

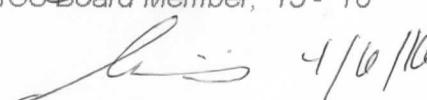
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NIRRY CHIEN G. MARAÑON

IICS Board Member, '15 - '16

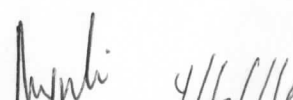
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MARY LOURAINÉ M. MONEDERO

IICS Board Member, '15 - '16

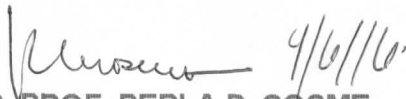
 4/6/16
KIM BENEDICT D. OAMIL

IICS Board Member, '15 - '16

Noted by:

 4/6/16
ENGR. DIVINAGRACIA R. MARIANO

IICS Adviser, '15 - '16

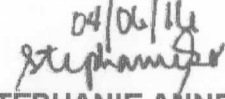
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ASSOC. PROF. PERLA P. COSME

IICS Adviser, '15 - '16

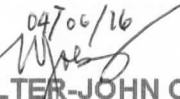
Ratified by the student body, through the ICSSC Interim Executive Board 2015-2016 of the Institute of Information and Computing Sciences,

this _____ day of _____, 2016.

Certified by:

04/06/16

STEPHANIE ANNE GO

*Special Committee Chairperson, UST CENTRAL-IICS
COMELEC*

04/06/16

WALTER-JOHN CES

*Special Committee Secretary to the Adjudicatory, UST
CENTRAL-IICS COMELEC*

4/6/16

ELLISION DANIEL ALBA

*Special Committee Legal Head, UST CENTRAL-IICS
COMELEC*

4/6/16

ALYSSA LORRAINE ARREOLA
Chairperson, UST Central COMELEC

Endorsed by:


ENGR. ALEX A. SANTOS

Director, Institute of Information and Computing Sciences

4/6/16

REV. FR. HERMEL O. PAMA, O.P.

Regent, Institute of Information and Computing Sciences

References:

*Constitution of the Central Student Council, University
of Santo Tomas, 2002*

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